

Korean panokseons at Hansando
The workhorse of Yi Sunshin's navy at all his famous victories over the Japanese was the *panokseon*, a reliable, maneuverable platform for the Korean archers and artillery.

KEY

JAPANESE FLEET

4–5 Japanese war galleys (*sekibune* or *atakebune*)

4–5 Japanese scout ships

KOREAN FLEET

4–5 Korean *panokseons* (unless otherwise stated)

1 Korean *kobukson* (turtle ship)

1 THE LURE AND THE TRAP

Yi Sunshin sends six ships forward to lure the Japanese fleet into following them into open water, where he carefully deploys his fleet in a "crane's wing" formation. The Japanese commander Wakizaka obliges by taking the bait.

MIRUK ISLAND

KOREAN MAINLAND

HWADO ISLAND

HANSANDO ISLAND

A number of *panokseons* are held in reserve

The six ships sent forward by Yi Sunshin race back to the main fleet with the Japanese in hot pursuit

The Korean "turtle ships" are deployed in the center

The Japanese fleet, led by the scout ships, pursues the decoy ships into open water

The majority of the Korean ships deploy in a "crane's wing" formation. This allows interlocking fields of fire—they can fire on the enemy ships from several angles

The main fleet is still unaware of the size of the Korean fleet waiting in ambush

MIRUK ISLAND

KOREAN MAINLAND

Kyonnaeryang Strait

HWADO ISLAND

HANSANDO ISLAND

Cannon fire keeps the Japanese at a distance so their soldiers have no chance to grapple and board the Korean ships

The "turtle ships" hold the Korean center, their spiked decks making it impossible for the Japanese to board them

The impetuous Japanese commander Wakizaka orders his ships straight into the waiting Korean trap

The wings close in around the Japanese fleet, causing their ships to collide with each other, making it harder and harder for them to maneuver

As the Korean "crane's wing" formation encircles the Japanese, reserve ships move up to plug the gaps in the expanding line

2 CLOSING THE TRAP

The Japanese rush headlong into the Korean trap to be met by a withering barrage of cannon fire and fire arrows from three sides. Many Japanese ships are soon set on fire or sunk and many of their soldiers are killed.